

Ezyloan - Meta WhatsApp Cloud API Setup

Official, direct WhatsApp integration (no Twilio middleman = cheaper). Code side is fully ready - you only add 6 keys to .env.local and restart. Then: form submit sends a WhatsApp message, and user replies get an auto-reply from the same Ezy AI brain as the website.

Meta Cloud API vs Twilio

The app supports both. As soon as the META_WHATSAPP_* keys are in .env.local, the app auto-uses Meta (Twilio becomes fallback). You can force it with WHATSAPP_PROVIDER=meta or =twilio.

- Meta Cloud API: Meta hosts it free; you pay ONLY Meta per-message rate (no markup). Needs a Meta Business + Developer app.
- Twilio (old): faster to start but adds Twilio markup (~\$0.005/msg) on top of Meta fees.

Prerequisites (what you need)

- A Facebook/Meta account (personal) - it creates your Business Manager.
- A phone number NOT active on any WhatsApp / WhatsApp Business app (delete that account first, e.g. for +91 97772 28844).
- Business documents (GST / company registration / bank statement / utility bill) for verification.

Phase 1 - Create a Meta Business Account

- Go to business.facebook.com -> Create account.
- Business name "Ezyloan", your name, business email.
- Business Settings -> Business Info: fill in the details.

Phase 2 - Create a Developer App + add WhatsApp

1. developers.facebook.com -> My Apps -> Create App.
2. Use case Other -> type Business -> name it (e.g. "Ezyloan WhatsApp") and pick your Business Account.
3. On the app dashboard find the "WhatsApp" product -> Set up.
4. You will now see: a Meta-provided test number + your WhatsApp Business Account (WABA), the Phone number ID and WhatsApp Business Account ID (note these), and a temporary 24h access token for testing.

Phase 3 - Add your number (+91 97772 28844)

- WhatsApp -> API Setup -> Add phone number.
- Display name "Ezyloan", category, business details.
- Enter +91 97772 28844 -> verify via OTP (SMS/call). The number must NOT be active on any WhatsApp app.
- After verifying you get a new Phone number ID - that goes in the env.

Phase 4 - Business Verification (needed for live sending)

- Business Settings -> Security Center (Business Verification).
- Upload documents: business registration / GST / utility bill / bank statement (name + address must match).
- Review usually takes a few hours to 2-5 days. After it, messaging limits grow (1K -> 10K -> unlimited/day).

Phase 5 - Create a PERMANENT access token (System User)

The temporary token expires in 24h. For live use create a permanent one:

- Business Settings -> Users -> System Users -> Add -> name "ezyloan-system", role Admin.

- On that system user: Add Assets -> Apps -> select your app -> Full control.
- Generate new token -> select the app -> tick permissions: whatsapp_business_messaging AND whatsapp_business_management.
- Set expiry Never -> Generate. Copy the long token (shown once). This is META_WHATSAPP_TOKEN.

Phase 6 - Create & approve a Message Template

A form-submit message is business-initiated, so it cannot be free text - it needs an approved template. (Auto-replies do not need a template; they go as free text inside the 24h window.)

- WhatsApp Manager -> Account tools -> Message templates -> Create template.
- Category Utility (or Marketing). Language English (en). Name: lead_confirmation.

Body uses {{1}} for the first name:

```
Hello {{1}}! Thank you for reaching out to Ezyloan. Our team
will contact you shortly. Ezyloan is a loan facilitator (not a
lender) and works with multiple Banks/NBFCs. Call
+91 6372977626 or visit www.ezyloan.co.in
```

- Submit -> approval takes minutes to a few hours. The template NAME (lead_confirmation) and LANGUAGE (en) go in the env.

Phase 7 - Configure the webhook (for auto-reply)

- App dashboard -> WhatsApp -> Configuration.
- Callback URL: https://ezyloan.co.in/api/whatsapp/webhook
- Verify token: any secret string you choose (this is META_WHATSAPP_VERIFY_TOKEN).
- Click Verify and save - Meta sends a GET check and the code matches it automatically.
- Webhook fields -> Subscribe -> "messages" (this is required).
- App Secret: App dashboard -> Settings -> Basic -> App Secret -> Show -> copy (META_WHATSAPP_APP_SECRET). It verifies inbound message signatures.

Phase 8 - Add 6 keys to .env.local and restart

```
# --- Meta WhatsApp Cloud API (add these 6) ---
META_WHATSAPP_TOKEN=EAAG...           # Phase 5 permanent token
META_WHATSAPP_PHONE_NUMBER_ID=1234567890 # Phase 3 phone number ID
META_WHATSAPP_VERIFY_TOKEN=meraSecret123 # Phase 7 chosen string
META_WHATSAPP_APP_SECRET=abcd1234...    # Phase 7 App Secret
META_WHATSAPP_TEMPLATE_NAME=lead_confirmation # Phase 6 name
META_WHATSAPP_TEMPLATE_LANG=en          # template language

# optional force: WHATSAPP_PROVIDER=meta
```

Restart the server. Done: form submit -> template message to the user; user reply -> Ezy AI auto-reply (same brain as the website) from the same number. WHATSAPP_DEFAULT_COUNTRY_CODE=91 is already set (prepends +91 to 10-digit numbers).

Plan & Pricing (Meta) - approximate

There is NO monthly plan/subscription fee. Meta charges PER MESSAGE (per-message model since 1 July 2025). Cloud API hosting is free. You just add a payment method (card) to the WABA: Business Settings -> WhatsApp Accounts -> [WABA] -> Payment settings.

Category	When	India approx (USD/msg)
Service	User messaged first (24h window) - auto-reply	Free
Utility	Order/lead update inside open window	Free or ~0.0014
Authentication	OTP	~0.0014
Marketing	Promo / business-initiated	~0.0107 - 0.014

- For Ezyloan: user-reply auto-reply = FREE (service window).
- Form-submit confirmation (template) = Utility -> very cheap (~1 paisa/msg), often free inside the window.

WARNING: rates change over time and are India-specific. Always check the official rate card: <https://developers.facebook.com/docs/whatsapp/pricing> . Billing: WhatsApp Manager -> Insights / Billing.

No BSP needed: using Meta Cloud API directly means no third-party (Twilio, Gupshup) monthly fee - only Meta per-message charges.

Test & confirm

- Submit the website form from a test number -> server log shows "Meta WhatsApp sent" and the template arrives.
- Message your Ezyloan WhatsApp from that number -> an auto-reply should arrive.
- Admin -> Ezy AI Brain -> Needs Training -> WhatsApp tab shows questions the bot could not answer; click Teach to train it.

AI training - same as website, for WhatsApp too

WhatsApp and the website share ONE Ezy AI brain. Whatever you teach in Admin -> Ezy AI Brain applies to both. The Needs Training tab now has a Website / WhatsApp filter so you can train WhatsApp questions separately.

Common errors (seen in logs)

Meta code	Meaning	Fix
190	Access token invalid/expired	Regenerate permanent token (Phase 5)
131047	24h window closed; free text blocked	Set META_WHATSAPP_TEMPLATE_NAME
131030	Recipient not on test allow-list	Add number or use live/verified number
132000/1	Template mismatch / not approved	Match name+lang; wait for approval
verify fail	Webhook verify token mismatch	Env token = dashboard token